

# **LANGUAGE OF HEALTHCARE**

## **ARTICULATE TO TREAT**

**ENGLISH – KANNADA PHRASE BOOK**



**The White Army Publication**

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## INTRODUCTION

Imagine yourself eliciting history from a patient in a language you don't speak or write. The patient knows only the local language which you cannot understand. Trying to communicate through signs has also failed. What would you do then?

Such a situation is a very common occurrence in a country like ours where the number of languages spoken from region to region skyrocket in harmonic progression. Establishing an effective communication becomes very difficult in such a situation due to lack of mutual knowledge of a common dialect. The very aim of a doctor which is to impart healthcare and counsel then becomes futile. Hence, only medical knowledge is not sufficient for a doctor. Being able to communicate this medical knowledge for the benefit of the masses is what is more important. Thus, it is imperative to be able to communicate in a dialect which the patient understands so as to console, convince and counsel, the three important features of an empathetic doctor.

With this very aim and motto, this book is a humble attempt to bridge the loopholes and gaps in communication. Commonly used words and questions asked have been translated into Kannada from English with the sole aim to help medical students and also healthcare professionals to build a good rapport with the patients and provide the best of care and cure. We hope this handy manual will soon be your best friend and be there for you through thick and thin. It is however a well-established fact that practice makes one perfect. Hence, only by repeated practice of speaking will help one master the art of effective communication.



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# **VOCABULARY**

## **PRONOUNS**

| ENGLISH | KANNADA     |
|---------|-------------|
| I       | Naanu       |
| We      | Naavu       |
| My      | Nanna       |
| Our     | Namma       |
| Me      | Naanu       |
| You     | Neenu       |
| Your    | Ninna/Nimma |
| He/she  | Avanu/Avalu |
| Him/her | Avana/Avala |
| They    | Avaru       |
| Their   | Avara       |
| This    | Idu         |
| These   | Ivugalu     |
| That    | Adu         |
| Those   | Avugalu     |

## **INTERROGATION**

| ENGLISH  | KANNADA  |
|----------|----------|
| Why      | Yaake    |
| Who      | Yaaru    |
| When     | Yaavaga  |
| Where    | Elli     |
| What     | Enu      |
| What for | Ethakke  |
| Which    | Yaava    |
| How ever | Hegadaru |
| How      | Hege     |



## PREPOSITIONS AND CONJUNCTIONS

| ENGLISH     | KANNADA            |
|-------------|--------------------|
| After       | Aamele/Nanthara    |
| Before      | Munche             |
| Inside / in | Olage              |
| Outside     | Horage             |
| Out         | Horage             |
| And         | Matthu             |
| Or          | Athava             |
| More        | Hecchu             |
| But         | Aadare             |
| Also        | Aadaru             |
| Almost      | Bahutheka          |
| Soon        | Bega               |
| Slowly      | Mellage            |
| Suddenly    | Iddhakkiddhanthe   |
| Across      | Addalaagi          |
| Again       | Matthe             |
| If so       | Haagiddalli        |
| If not so   | Haage illavaadalli |
| Tall        | Eththara           |
| Short       | Kullage            |
| Fat         | Dappa              |
| Lean        | Thellage           |



## **PATIENT'S DETAILS**

1. What is your name?  
Nimma hesaru enu?
2. How old are you?  
Nimage eshtu vayassu? / nimma vayassu eshtu?
3. Where do you come from?  
Neevu ellinda bandiddiri?
4. What job do you do?  
Neevu enu kelasa madtira?
5. When did you get admitted in the hospital?  
Neevu aaspathrege seriddu( admit aagiddu ) yaavaga?

## **CHIEF COMPLAINTS**

6. What is the problem?  
Nimage enu thondare ide?
7. For how long are you having this problem?  
Nimage ee thondare yavaaginda ide?

## **HISTORY OF PRESENTILLNESS**

8. What type of pain?  
Yaava tarahada novu



9. How did it start?  
Hege ( Yaava thara ) shuru aaytu?
10. Where is the site of pain?  
Novu elli ( yaava jaagadalli) ide?
11. Where did it start first?  
Modalu elli shuru aaytu?
12. Did it(pain) remain in the same place?  
Novu ade jaagadalli ittha ?
13. What is the site of origin?  
Novu yaava jaagadinda shuru aagutthe?
14. Any relieving factors?  
Novu kadime aagoke enadru madthira?
15. Is the pain associated with vomiting & fever?  
Novina jote vaanti matthe jwara ideya?
16. When the pain extends to another site, is the pain still seen at the site of origin?  
Novu bere jaagakke hodhaga munche idda jaagadalli novuttha ?



17. How is your appetite?  
Hasivu hegide ?
18. Do you get good sleep at the night?  
Raatri nidde channaagi maadthira ?
19. Do you pass stool regularly?  
Prati dina mala visarjnege ( eradakke ) sariyagi  
hogtira ?
20. Is stool watery/ soft/ hard?  
Mala neer thara / meduvaagi / gatti iruttha ?
21. How is urine?  
Mootra ( ondu ) sariyagi maadtidira ?
22. How much is volume?  
Eshtu mootra madtira ?( nimma mootrada parimaana  
estu? )
23. What is the colour of urine? Is it red/ yellow/ black?  
Moothrada banna hegirutthe ? kempu/haladi/kappu  
bannairuttha?

### **QUESTIONS PERTAINING TO CNS CASES**

24. Where did the weakness appeared first?  
Modhalu yava jagadhalli bala kadime ide anta ansiththu?



## Language Learning Tips

1. Conversation, Conversation, Conversation. The only secret to learning a new language. The reason is that language is something that needs to be processed, not memorized.
2. Language requires a lot of repetition, a lot of reference experiences, and a consistent commitment.
3. Start with the most common words and then make sentences with them over and over again. Learn just enough grammar to be able to do this and do it until you feel comfortable with all of them.
4. Carry a pocket dictionary. This will make a huge difference in learning.
5. You may say a lot of wrong things. Accept it. Absolutely there is no harm.
6. Figure out pronunciation patterns.
  - i. All words that end in 'ya' in kokborok indicate a negative answer.
  - ii. Most words are same. For example 'bahai' is used for both how and smell. But the tone is what differentiates them. In kokborok Say 'bahai' in a interrogative tone when saying how (stress on 'ba') and when saying smell (stress on 'hai')
7. After learning the common words, focus on becoming conversational. Studies have shown that the most common 100 words in any language account for 50% of all spoken communication.
8. “How do you say X?” is the most important sentence you can possibly learn. Learn it early and use it often.



9. When you learn a new word, try to use it a few times right away. When you stop and look up a new word in conversation, make a point to use it in the next two or three sentences you say. Language learning studies show that you need to hit a certain amount of repetitions of saying a word within one minute of learning it, one hour of learning it, one day, etc.
10. Most people are helpful, let them help.
11. These are the phases you go through. First, you're able to speak a little and understand nothing. Then you're able to understand far more than you speak. Then you become conversational, but it requires quite a bit of mental effort. After that, you're able to speak and understand without conscious mental effort (i.e., you don't have to translate words into your native tongue in your mind). Once you're able to speak and listen without thinking about it, you'll begin to actually think in the new language.
12. Finally, find a way to make it fun. As with anything, if you're going to stick to it, you have to find a way to make it fun.











